

Captain William and the Robodog Invasion

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The Peculiar Saturday Morning

It was a normal Saturday for everybody in America, but for me, William, it was anything other than normal. ACERS (American Center for Exploration and Research in Space), the company that I work for, just received something odd, which suddenly summoned me urgently to the lab at 7 am.

I grumpily went off my bed, shutting off my screaming phone. Taking the first shirt and pants I could find in my closet, I ate my not-so-great breakfast of a microwaved burrito. I took my car key when the phone rang AGAIN!!!! Do these people know something called "Patience? I yet again shut my phone off, rush for my car, and run into my neighbor, who is obviously not happy.

"It's a SATURDAY!!! Can't I ever sleep in peace?? Always something is going wrong with you and that company. What's it called again?? ACNES???", said my next-door neighbor, Will. "It's ACERS.", I said.

Will starts speaking again, but I ignore him and get in my car. Putting my phone to SILENT (I can't tolerate noise while driving). I start the car and get on the road. "It's probably nothing serious", I said. ACERS never needed him urgently. Even if they need urgent work to be done, I'm not the only astro-scientist, right? ACERS has many qualified astronauts and scientists. It must be my boss, hooking me up to work I don't want to do. No wonder everybody dislikes him.

The Mysterious Figure Awaits

I reach ACERS, and there, armed guards welcome me in. I hear faint ringing alarms. I go inside to meet a jumble of scientists, astronauts, security, and managers. The

security team leads me to the source of the alarm, and oh boy, it's as loud as a volcanic eruption. I cover my ears. A pair of scientists handed me noise-cancelling headphones. I wear them. "That's much better", I say, but that can't be heard over the resonating siren. "Captain William", I hear on the noise-cancelling headphones. Looks like these headphones are so high tech that they can communicate with others wearing headphones. "Something triggered the alarm", said my boss on the headphones. "I know", I say grumbily. "Looks like something bad is about to happen", said my boss. "I KNOW!" I said. "So we called you", said my boss. "I KNOW!!! NOW WHAT TRIGGERED THE ALARM?" I said. "A scientist joins the conversation in my headphones. "Our systems at ACERS detected an abnormal being in our Solar System. We currently can't identify it, but it looks a lot like a spaceship. We detected a thermal signal inside the ship, indicating the presence of a being in the ship. "So what's the problem with a random dude hanging out in our Solar System?" "You see, the alien, sorry, the 'abnormal being', isn't hanging out in the Solar System. It's a party crasher. Literally. Pun intended". "Wait, so you're saying that some random spaceship with a living creature is headed towards EARTH???? and YOU here are making PUNS here?? Instead of trying to find a solution, you are making jokes???? The Earth could be demolished! Humanity could end forever!!! AND YOU!!! YOU ARE MAKING JOKES!!! THAT TOO PUNS!?!?". "That's why we called you!", said the scientist. "You are going to help save humanity! Good luck!" said the scientist, who exited the chat in our headphones. I would have settled for dealing with financial stocks and budgets rather than putting humanity in my hands.

The Mistake

I quickly thought of a good idea. It seemed like a good idea. But sending a rocket to space is costly, so this better work.

I told the scientists and whoever could hear me on those headphones my decision. It might have been the craziest decision I ever made. My boss became shocked; the scientists went crazy (they already were crazy due to the alarm, so now they are just even crazier), and the astronauts almost fainted. I told them to prepare the rocket for a journey to the 'thing'.

"HOPEFULLY YOU KNOW THE HATING IN OUR HEADS. IT'S CALLED A 'BRAIN', AND IT'S USED FOR MAKING DECISIONS. IT LOOKS LIKE YOU DON'T HAVE IT NOW, DO YOU, WILLIAM?" said my boss. "You told me to SAVE the world. I just did what you told me to do. Now, follow my orders or else I'll just leave. Because apparently everybody else here is as prepared as a toddler wanting to cook with a butter knife and toy spatula. If this were a group thing, you'd be the guys bringing glittery sparkly glue while I here am diffusing bombs." "OOHHHHHHH THAT'S A GREAT

ROAST!!!!", said everybody, not realizing the roast applied to them also.

The bird takes flight.

As the rocket was loading with fuel, I checked the monitors. It was 9 (2 hours passed already??) The being was only 240,000 miles. (That's about the distance from our Earth to the moon!) With some rough calculations, I find out that after exactly 2 days, the rocket and the weird spacecraft thing would come together with us on a path and catch us both on a small orbit around the moon. That would give us plenty of time to study the ship. The rocket was supposed to be ready at 12:56 am (CST), which meant I had to get a bad night of sleep (WHY IS MY SLEEP SO AFFECTED TODAY????).

The time is 12:40, and the spacecraft is just getting its final checks. YAWN. I'm so tired I'm not sure I could go back home by driving. I slept at 11 yesterday and woke up at 7 am. today. Who knew I would wake up at 7 on a SATURDAY morning? And then tomorrow I have to wake up at 9 (pew, 9, not 7) and go back to ACERS to check the progress of the spacecraft. The astronauts go into the spacecraft, and the rocket is almost ready for launch. I weirdly feel a feeling of nervousness.

Suddenly, out of nowhere, a security member comes and tells me the most terrible news. I would have never heard in my life.

"So, William, you know, we kind of...", says the guard. "WHAT?", I say. "We kind of... changed your roles in the project", he says quickly. "So what am I doing now?" I say. This can't be good. "SO, instead of tracking progress on the spacecraft, you are... part of the astronauts. Talk about a career that's out of this world! You're definitely going places."

Oh no. This can't be happening. This is all a dream, I say to myself. All a dream. The security guard pinches my cheek and says, "Oh, this is totally happening, and it's real, he says, with a hearty laugh. "NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!!!!", I say. He ushers me to the rocket. I'm so tired I actually follow his orders! It's 5 minutes before launch. The moment I get inside the rocket seat, I doze off. You can't blame me. I haven't had proper sleep since morning. The next thing I know, we lift off.

A rough journey ahead

The rocket takes off. I am suddenly jolted by the sudden movement of the rocket. It roars. I wake up. "AAAAARRRRRRGGGGGGHHHHHBLAHHBBBBHBUMMMMM", I say. The other astronauts look at me in the most peculiar way. Embarrassed, I stop thinking about it and look into the window. It's not my first time in a rocket. It's my

first time in a rocket while sleeping. I doze off.

The next Sunday morning

I wake up feeling refreshed. The other astronauts are eating their breakfast. I look for my brush and don't seem to find it. "A space adventure a day keeps the dentist away", I say. I grab my breakfast burrito (Breakfast burritos are really nice for almost anything) and start eating. I silently wish I had my brush. The burrito has a nasty taste without it. I get to know the other astronauts. The one on my right-hand side is James, who is a new astronaut. Maybe ACERS did run out of proper astronauts to do their work after all. The other astronaut is called Paul, who has about 2 years of experience in radios, lasers, and all that's tech. He's a friendly guy. The one to my extreme left is called Lisa. She is an actual astronaut who actually guided the Mars rover. She is not friendly and looks very grumpy. Note to self: Find out if Lisa is angry or not. Until then, I think I'll just...stay out of her way.

The Face-Off in Lunar Orbit

"Thirty seconds to orbit insertion," Lisa muttered, her fingers flying across the control panel. She still looked grumpy, but at least she knew how to fly this metal bird.

"Everyone, helmets on," Paul said, checking his laser and radio frequencies. "If they start broadcasting alien heavy metal music, I'm ready to jam their signals."

I strapped myself tightly into my seat. Through the thick glass of the cockpit, the dark side of the moon loomed like a giant, scarred golf ball. And then, we saw it.

The "spaceship" didn't look like a classic flying saucer. It looked like a giant, metallic dog bowl, glowing with an eerie purple neon light. As we slipped into the moon's orbit right next to it, a massive hatch on the top of the bowl slid open.

"Uh, Captain William?" James squeaked, pointing out the window. "I don't think it's a random dude in there."

Out of the hatch floated hundreds of metallic, glowing red spheres. As they cleared the ship, they unfolded. Metal legs popped out. Mechanical tails started wagging. Sharp, chrome jaws snapped open and shut in the vacuum of space.

"Are those... robotic dogs?" I gasped.

"They aren't looking for treats, William!" Lisa yelled, pulling the thruster joystick hard to the left.

Suddenly, a giant video screen on our dashboard flickered to life, overriding ACERS' secure network. A massive, metallic dog face with glowing green eyes and a tiny, evil-looking space helmet filled the screen.

"ATTENTION EARTH-MUTTS," a robotic, bark-like voice boomed through our speakers. "I AM BARK-BOT 3000. WE HAVE RUN OUT OF SPACE-BONES ON OUR PLANET. WE ARE HERE TO TAKE OVER YOUR PLANET, TURN YOUR TOWNS INTO CARDBOARD CHEW TOYS, AND ALL YOUR CARS. RESISTANCE IS MUTT-ILE."

"Oh great," I groaned, rubbing my temples. "Even the alien invaders are making terrible puns. This truly is the worst weekend of my life."

The Dooms Day

So, it was the worst weekend of William's life. They started broadcasting heavy-metal music. The music did not affect the robot dogs; in fact, the robo-dogs liked it. Soon, the robo-dogs became aggressive and started attacking.

The aircraft was full of chaos, except for William's mind. He thought of going out of the aircraft to fight, but the next second, even before he could open the door, one of the robo-dogs had destroyed the rocket's legs.

Before William could blink, he and his crew were on a weird-looking planet. Suddenly, a huge monster came out of nowhere. Then, a small kid named Zayan arrived in his spaceship to help. However, the little boy accidentally dropped them on another strange planet. William just wished he was home—life was super crazy outside Earth. On this new planet, the inhabitants spoke a language called Blaberic.

William asked Paul, "Do you think we could go back to Earth?"

Paul replied, "Even I want to go back to Earth, but we have lost everything."

James' eyes caught sight of something—it was a rocket, for free. He exclaimed, "Yay! There is a way back home!" So, the crew boarded the aircraft.

1 day later

The crew arrived on Earth and were astonished to discover the existence of robodogs. They were now considered ACERS' property, serving as pets and cargo

movers. The massive robodog, Bhuck, was eliminated when the rocket crashed into the ship, causing it to explode. Consequently, the robodogs were reprogrammed to show kindness, cuteness, and helpfulness. As for William, he...was back home. His boss gave him a salary raise (suggested by the scientists (I kind of like them now!)). My boss also gave me 1 week of vacation, because this trip stole 4 naps from me, and now I care more about sleep than ever.

At home:

So... what now? As for me, I'm going for a very long nap. zzzzzzz

Thanks For Reading!

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